Data Analyst vs Product Analyst

Same SQL. Different questions.

Data Analyst

Answers

- What happened in the business, and why?
- Sales fell in March: which region, which product

Serves the whole business.

Product Analyst

Answers

- How do people use the app, and what should change?
- Where users drop off before paying

Serves one product team.

Data Analyst

Same table, different question

- Which region sold the most?

```
SELECT region, SUM(amount) FROM orders GROUP BY
region;
```

Business result.

Product Analyst

Same table, different question

- How many orders end up cancelled or returned?

```
SELECT status, COUNT(*) FROM orders GROUP BY status;
```

User behaviour.

Data Analyst

Daily tools

- Excel, SQL
- Power BI or Tableau
- Some Python (pandas)

Product Analyst

Daily tools

- SQL, a lot of it
- Event tools like Mixpanel or Amplitude
- Sheets, some Python

Data Analyst

A normal day

- Refresh the sales dashboard
- Answer a manager's quick question
- Clean a messy Excel export

Product Analyst

A normal day

- Check yesterday's sign-up funnel
- Size a feature idea with event data
- Read an A/B test with the product manager

Data Analyst

Interviews ask

- SQL joins and GROUP BY
- Lookups and pivots in Excel
- Walk me through your dashboard

Product Analyst

Interviews ask

- SQL on event tables
- How would you measure this feature?
- Read this A/B test result

Data Analyst

Entry route for freshers

- Excel + SQL + one BI tool
- 2-3 dashboard projects on sales or HR data

Hired in almost every industry.

Product Analyst

Entry route for freshers

- Strong SQL + product sense
- A funnel or retention project on app data

Mostly product companies and startups.

Data Analyst

Pick it if you...

- Like turning messy data into a clear report
- Want options in any industry, any city

A good first analyst job.

Product Analyst

Pick it if you...

- Use apps and wonder why people quit them
- Enjoy experiments and arguing about metrics

Easier after 1-2 years as an analyst.

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